

Be a More Savvy Consumer

Unemployment remains stubbornly high, and even higher for those just starting out in the professional world. The number of real estate foreclosures remains high as well, and although we have resumed saving, debt is still at or near historic highs. Now is the time to scrutinize your spending habits. Perhaps you were forced to cut back or give up certain things during the recession that you thought you couldn't live without. Keep living without them! Try avoiding credit purchases unless you know you have the cash to pay for them. This will help you avoid taking drastic measures the next time the economy retrenches.



ESSENTIAL

Remember, attitude matters. Even in the postrecession period, think of budgeting as eating right rather than being on a diet. You eat what you want in moderate amounts, you don't binge, you don't deprive yourself, and yet you end up better off.
